PHOTOBOOTH KEYCHAIN PRINTING SYSTEM

How to Print Keychain Strips with Frame Collage

A complete operator guide for preparing, previewing, and gang-printing acrylic keychain inserts at 100% true scale using custom frames on 4R, A4, and Letter paper.

Why Exact Scaling is Critical for Keychains

Acrylic keychain casings have fixed, rigid cavities. If your print is even 1 mm too wide, it will buckle or wrinkle; if it is scaled down by a "Fit to Page" driver setting, it leaves loose gaps inside the casing. This guide walks you through setting up pixel-perfect 1:3 keychain strips (2.5 × 7.5 in and 2 × 6 in) and printing multiple copies on a single sheet.

Paper Size vs. Keychain Sizing Matrix

Paper Size	Paper Dimensions	Max Keychain Size (100% Scale)	Capacity per Sheet	Status
A4 Paper	210 × 297 mm (8.27 × 11.69 in)	**2.5 × 7.5 in** (63.5 × 190.5 mm)	**3 upright** (or 4 sideways)	EXACT 100% SCALE
US Letter	216 × 279 mm (8.5 × 11 in)	**2.5 × 7.5 in** (63.5 × 190.5 mm)	**3 upright** side-by-side	EXACT 100% SCALE
8R / 8×10	203 × 254 mm (8 × 10 in)	**2.5 × 7.5 in** (63.5 × 190.5 mm)	**3 upright** side-by-side	EXACT 100% SCALE
4R (4×6 in)	102 × 152 mm (4 × 6 in)	**2.0 × 6.0 in** (Classic Mini Strip)	**2 upright** side-by-side	EXACT 100% SCALE
4R (4×6 in)	102 × 152 mm (4 × 6 in)	2.5 × 7.5 in (Requires shrinking)	1 – 2 strips	SHRUNK TO ~80% (2.0×6.0 IN)

Critical Rule on 4R Paper: Standard 4R paper is physically 6.0 inches tall. A 7.5 in strip physically exceeds 4R paper length. If you need true 2.5 × 7.5 in acrylic inserts, you **must** load A4, Letter, or 8R paper. If using 4R paper, purchase 2.0 × 6.0 in or 1.8 × 5.5 in keychain blanks.

Quick-Start 3-Step Summary

1. Template
Create 750 × 2250 px (300 DPI) PNG with transparent photo windows.

2. Arrangement
Pick **Frame collage** in Step 3, choose A4, and select **3 strips** pattern.

3. 100% Printing
Toggle Keychain ON. Set driver scale to **100% (Actual Size)** and Borderless **OFF**.

STEP 1 & STEP 2

Designing Your Template & Uploading into Booth

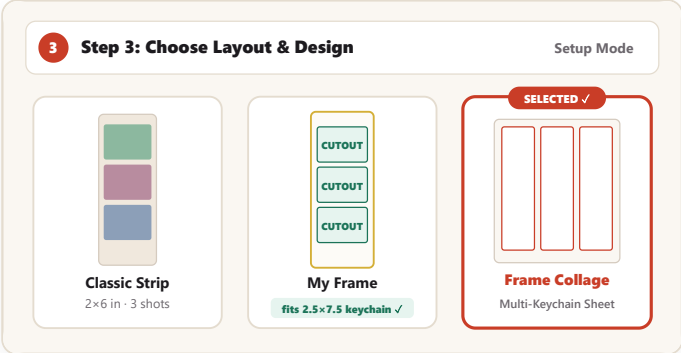
1. **Design at 300 DPI Resolution:**
   Create your frame canvas in Photoshop, Canva, or Illustrator:
   - **2.5 × 7.5 in: 750 × 2250 px** (or 1500 × 4500 px for 600 DPI).
   - **2.0 × 6.0 in: 600 × 1800 px** (for 4R photo paper).

2. **Cut Out Transparent Photo Windows:**
   Leave 2, 3, or 4 cutout boxes where guest photos should appear. The windows must have an **alpha transparent background** or pure solid white (#FFFFFF).

3. **Maintain 3 mm Safe Margins:**
   Keep names, wedding dates, and logos at least 35 px inside the cut border so trimming does not clip them. Export as a transparent **PNG**.

4. **Upload in Step 3 (Layout / Design):**
   In booth setup, go to **Step 3 → Frames with photo spots** → Click **+ Add frame**. The booth auto-detects all windows and confirms:

```
strip · fits 2.5x7.5 keychain ✓
```



Step 3 Layout Cards: Select the **Frame collage** card to arrange multiple keychain strips on a single sheet.

Template Checklist

- **Aspect Ratio:** Exactly 1:3 vertical ratio (e.g., 750 × 2250 px).
- **Color Space:** sRGB, 8-bit PNG with transparent alpha channel.
- **Photo Windows:** 100% transparent cutouts or pure white (#FFFFFF).
- **Safe Margins:** Keep text ≥ 35 px (3 mm) away from cut lines.

Photo Window Detection: The booth automatically counts transparent cutout rectangles. If your frame has 3 windows, the booth automatically programs each session to capture 3 shots.

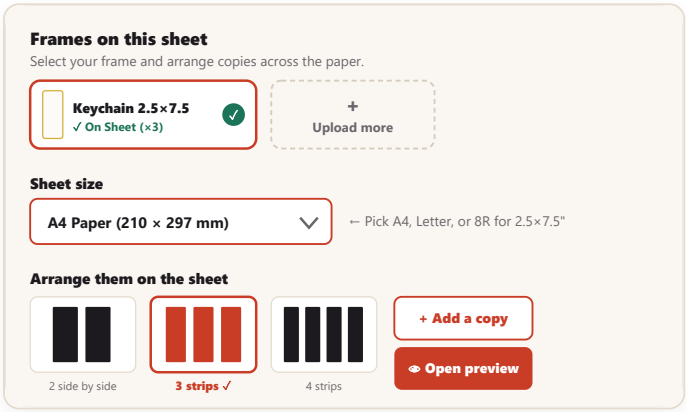
STEP 3 & STEP 4

Arranging Multiple Keychains on the Sheet

1. Sheet Controls (Step 3)

In the **Frames on this sheet** panel:

- **Put Frame on Sheet:** Tap your uploaded frame (it will show a checkmark ✓).
- **Sheet Size:** Choose **A4**, **Letter**, or **8×10** for 2.5 × 7.5 in keychains (or **4×6** for 2x6 mini strips).
- **Pattern:** Pick **3 strips** for A4 upright, or **2 side by side** for 4R.
- **Add Copies:** Tap **+ Add a copy** so duplicate strips fill all slots. Captured photos fill all strips at once!

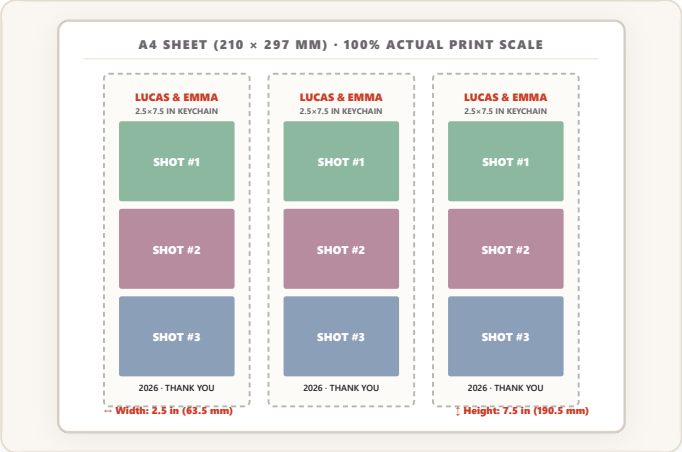


Sheet Controls: Pick the frame, set Sheet size to A4, select 3 strips, and add copies.

2. Interactive Sheet Preview

Click **Open preview** (eye icon) to inspect the sheet:

- **Spacing:** Drag any strip to fine-tune margins between cuts.
- **Photo Population:** All 3 strips populate with the session photos.
- **Cut Guidelines:** Dashed gray lines indicate where to trim.



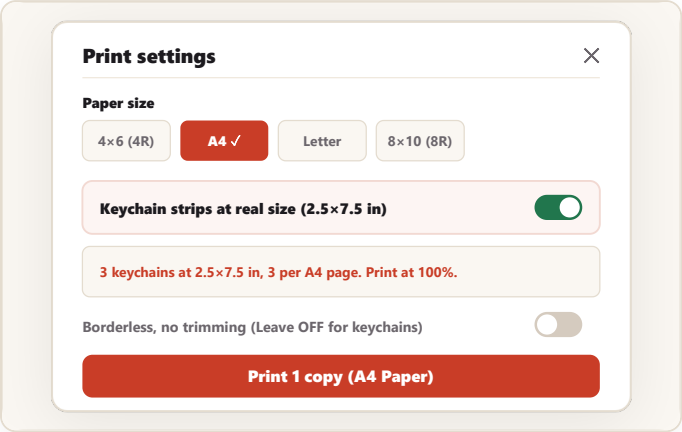
Preview Canvas: 3 real-size keychains laid out on A4 paper with dashed cutting lines.

Operator Tip — Test on Plain Paper: Before printing on premium 260 gsm photo paper, print 1 test copy on ordinary office paper. Hold the cut paper behind an empty acrylic casing to double-check that window borders and text margins align perfectly.

STEP 5 & ASSEMBLY

Printer Driver Scaling & Acrylic Assembly

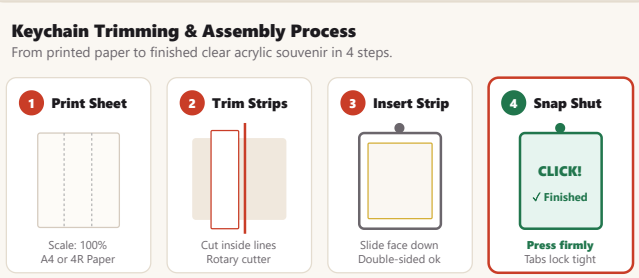
1. Print Settings & Keychain Mode



Print Settings UI: Select A4 paper and toggle ON **Keychain strips at real size (2.5×7.5 in)**. The booth automatically calculates 3 strips per page at 100% scale.

Driver Setting	Required Value	Why
Scale / Sizing	100% / Actual Size	Never choose "Fit to Page" or "Shrink". It distorts the 2.5 × 7.5 in dimensions.
Borderless	OFF (Normal Margins)	Borderless mode zooms the page by 2% to 4% to bleed off edges, which enlarges the strip.
Media Type	Photo Paper Glossy	Ensures rich contrast and droplet density.
Print Quality	High / Best	Produces sharp text, dates, and fine lines.

2. Trimming & Acrylic Assembly



4-Step Flow: Print at 100% → Trim along dashed guidelines → Slide into acrylic casing → Snap cover shut.

Assembly Best Practices

- **Paper Weight:** Use **200 to 260 gsm** glossy or luster photo paper. Thinner paper curls; thicker stock prevents the lid from clicking shut.
- **Trimming:** Use a rotary trimmer or craft knife. Cut right along the inside of the dashed gray lines.
- **Double-Sided:** Place two trimmed strips back-to-back inside the casing so both sides display photos.
- **Snap Shut:** Press the clear acrylic lid firmly into the recess until both locking tabs click.

Summary of Dimensions:

- **Keychain Strip (A4/Letter):** 750 × 2250 px (2.5 × 7.5 in)
- **Mini Strip (4R Paper):** 600 × 1800 px (2.0 × 6.0 in)
- **Resolution:** 300 DPI • **Aspect Ratio:** Exact 1:3 vertical